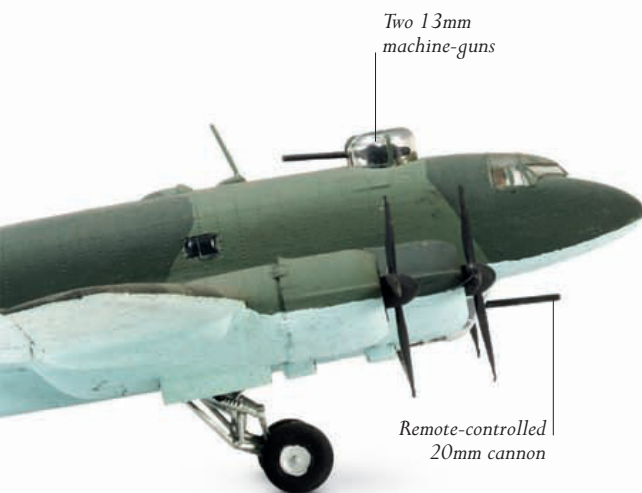




▲ SHORT S.25 SUNDERLAND

Launched	1938	Origin	UK
Wingspan	34.4m (112¾ft)		
Length	26m (85½ft)		
Top Speed	335kph (210mph)		
Engine	Four 794kW (1,065hp) Bristol Pegasus XVII radials		

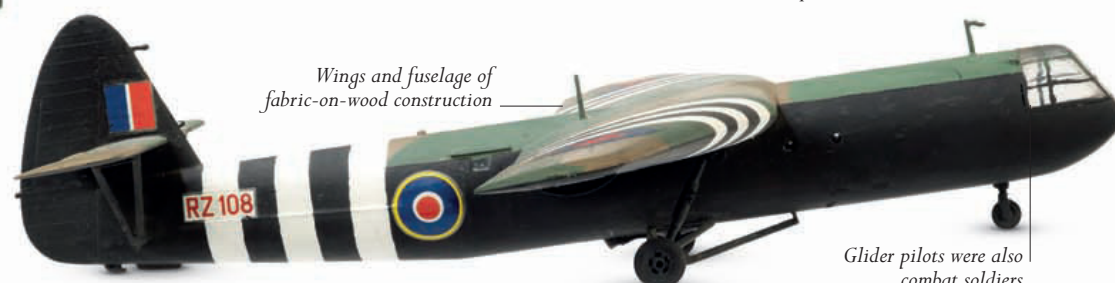
Developed from the successful Empire airliner, the Sunderland was the British Royal Air Force's principal patrol/reconnaissance bomber flying boat for 21 years. It was unusual in having "bomb rooms" where selected ordnance could be loaded on racks, which were then winched out under the wings and opened to unload the bombs.



▼ DOUGLAS C-47 SKYTRAIN

Launched	1936	Origin	US
Wingspan	29m (95¼ft)		
Length	19.7m (64¾ft)		
Top speed	370kph (230mph)		
Engine	Two 820kW (1,100hp) Wright R-1820 Cyclone radials		

Introduced as a commercial airliner by American Airlines, the DC-3 soon entered military service as the C-47. Over 10,000 were built for this purpose by 1945; some 400 were still in use at the end of the 20th century. A C-47 originally cost just under US\$80,000 to build.



▲ AIRSPEED HORSA GLIDER

Launched	1941	Origin	UK
Wingspan	26.8m (88ft)		
Length	20.4m (67ft)		
Top speed	160kph (100mph)		
Engine	None		

The Luftwaffe used gliders during the invasion of Belgium and France in 1940, and the British soon followed. The Horsa was larger than the German DFS 30, and could carry 25 troops. Some 4,000 were built, over 1,200 of which were expended in Operation Market Garden (see pp.372–73).



► SIKORSKY R-4 HOVERFLY

Launched	1943	Origin	US
Rotor diameter	11.5m (37¾ft)		
Length	10.2m (33¾ft)		
Top speed	120kph (75mph)		
Engine	149kW (200hp) Warner R-550 radial		

Developed from the experimental VS-300 for liaison and rescue work, the Hoverfly was the US Army Air Forces and the British Royal Air Force's first operational rotary-wing aircraft. A total of 131 were built up to 1944, when the type was superseded by the R-5.